

The Tall Grass Near Branford\*

by

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**SATURDAY**

## Opening TITLE SEQUENCE

**1. EXT. WINDY SEASIDE ROAD - DAY**

DALLAS (40s) and his son MAC (10) drive along a winding seaside road. The rugged coastline stretches beside them, with Atlantic waves crashing against the rocks. A storm brews in the distance, dark clouds gathering on the horizon.

**2. EXT. NEW HOUSE - SOUTHERN CONNECTICUT COAST - DAY**

Dallas signs papers on a clipboard handed to him by a MOVER. The Movers begin unloading boxes from the truck.

Nearby, a TV CAMERAMAN and a CAMERA CREW capture a REPORTER speaking into the camera. Mac watches from a distance, curious and uncertain about the commotion.

**3. EXT. NEW HOUSE - DRIVEWAY - DAY**

Dallas and Mac unload various items from a bucket in the back of their sedan. Among the items are an unfinished bird feeder and gardening tools.

Dallas pauses, staring somberly at the bucket. His emotions overwhelm for a moment.

Mac notices his father's hesitation and gently takes over, finishing the task without a word.

**4. INT. NEW HOUSE - MAC'S ROOM - DUSK**

Mac stands by the window, gazing out at the dimming light. Fireflies flicker in the tall grass. As the wind sways the branches, the fireflies' lights resemble the glint of eyes peering from the darkness.

Mac looks around the skies - clear.

## 5. INT. KITCHEN - NIGHT

Dallas carefully plates an avocado, an onion, and a sliced lemon--meticulously into small pieces and then reassembled to appear untouched. His movements are deliberate, almost ritualistic.

Mac sets the table and turns on the TV. He flips through channels until he finds the local weather report.

ON TV: The same REPORTER from earlier, standing outside their house, discusses the unpredictable weather this time of year.

Thunder rumbles in the distance, adding to the tension as the storm approaches.

**FADE OUT.**

Sunday

## 1. INT. CHURCH - MORNING

The PASTOR stands at the pulpit, addressing the congregation. The church is filled with attentive listeners, including DALLAS (40s) and MAC (10), sitting quietly in a pew.

PASTOR

"During ancient times, Israelites would make sacrifices of all kinds--grain, animals, even blood. But today, we know that blood sacrifice is no longer required."

The sermon concludes. The congregation begins to stir as they prepare to leave.

## 2. EXT. CHURCH FELLOWSHIP AREA - AFTERNOON

The church bustles with activity as congregates gather and plop iceberg lettuce on their plastic plates. Dallas and Mac stand awkwardly, each holding a plate of food. They stare at their plates, struggling to feel at ease.

A FRIENDLY MAN (50s), noticing their discomfort, approaches them with a welcoming smile.

FRIENDLY MAN

"Hey there, - hey (hey) where  
y'all from?"

DALLAS

"Indiana."

FRIENDLY MAN

"Indiana, huh? Never been - Well,  
welcome - Where are you living  
now?"

DALLAS

"Branford."

The Friendly Man's face lights up.

FRIENDLY MAN

"No way! I'm in Branford too! We  
have a BBQ going on tomorrow for  
Labor Day. Come through if you  
can"

Dallas nods politely, but he and Mac still seem out of  
place.

In the distance, Mac spots MOLLY (12) and ASHER (10)  
huddled over something. Asher holds a bunch of gear, while  
Molly waves what looks like weather instruments in the air.

The Friendly Man points toward a MINI FRIDGE near the  
coffee machine. A flyer pinned to the fridge reads: "23rd  
Annual Branford Harvest Sea Festival."

Dominic enters the scene - giving a nod to the friendly  
man.

DOMINIC

"See that? My cousin's in charge  
of the whole thing. It's the Sea  
Festival--a big deal around here.  
We do it every year to raise money  
for the Little League.

(MORE)

DOMINIC (CONT'D)

Borrow some stage equipment from the big arenas, get some local swashbuckle and jam bands to play... and of course, oysters for days. Not as famous as the Oyster Festival, but we hold our own."

Dallas listens politely, nodding along, but his attention drifts as the man continues to rattle on.

Makayla and Asher put something in a bag and put it under a tree. Mac doesn't say anything.

Cut To

The whole are at a church craft fair and they are

### **3. EXT. BRANFORD STREETS - EARLY EVENING**

Dallas and Mac walk home from church. The journey is a bit of a hike. They pass through the tall beech grass, a little pizzeria, a small post office, a free library mail post, and a mix of nice homes with boats docked nearby--some pristine, others not so much.

They continue past it all, into their corner of the world--a quiet cul-de-sac near a land preserve and a bird sanctuary.

They finally arrive home, exhausted, taking in the sight of their new house as the wind begins to pick up.

### **4. INT. NEW HOUSE - MAC'S ROOM - NIGHT**

Later that night, Mac looks out his bedroom window. The fireflies are out again, their soft glow dotting the landscape. The wind rustles the tall grass outside, making the fireflies flicker and blur.

As Mac focuses on the distance, the fireflies' lights begin to resemble eyes watching from the darkness, unsettling him.

FADE OUT.

# Monday

## 1. INT. SEDAN - MORNING

DALLAS, holding his phone with the latest iOS, follows Google Maps as they drive through town in their old sedan. The car's engine hums steadily as they approach the school. DALLAS glances at MAC (10), who sits quietly in the passenger seat, a mix of nervousness and anticipation on his face.

**DALLAS**

"Hope - you have a good day"

Mac nods, gripping his backpack tightly as they pull up to the school.

## 2. EXT. SCHOOL ENTRANCE - MORNING

Mac steps out of the sedan, looking up at the imposing structure of his new school. The sounds of chattering students and the ringing of the school bell fill the air. Dallas watches him from the car, giving a final nod before driving off.

## 3. INT. CLASSROOM - MORNING

Mac enters the classroom, glancing around nervously at the unfamiliar faces. He finds an empty seat and sits down, trying to blend in. The TEACHER, a man in his early 30s, stands at the front of the room, beginning his introduction.

**TEACHER**

"Good morning, everyone. Welcome to a new school year - a fresh start is what we have in front of us - hey you paying attention - semester, we'll be exploring some exciting topics--weather patterns, the phases of the moon, and how the tides work."

Mac listens intently, but his attention is soon drawn to the window. Outside, the sky is overcast, and a field of wetlands with tall grass stretches out beyond the schoolyard.

**4. EXT. SCHOOL YARD - AFTERNOON**

Mac sees ASHER (10) from afar, accompanied by MOLLY (12), the same girl from church. Molly hands Asher a bag, and Asher discreetly puts it in his backpack. Mac watches the exchange, his curiosity piqued.

**5. INT. SEDAN - AFTERNOON**

Dallas picks up Mac after school. As they drive home, they realize that Asher and MAKAYLA are their neighbors. The TALKATIVE NEIGHBOR from church approaches their car, greeting them enthusiastically.

**DOMINIC TALKATIVE NEIGHBOR**

"Hey, Indiana! Guess what? These kids are neighbors! Small world, huh?"

As a group of neighborhood kids approaches Mac, one of them, a GIRL (10), speaks up.

**MAKAYLA**

"Hey, did you see me give Asher that bag?"

**MAC**

(nodding)  
"Yeah."

Asher, looking sheepish, quickly walks away back to the house. Molly approaches Mac, looking him up and down.

**MAKAYLA**

(with a serious tone)  
"Can I trust you?"

**MAC**

"I think so."

Molly glances over at Dallas and the Talkative Neighbor, then back to Mac.

**MAKAYLA**

"Ask your dad if it's okay for you to come over after dinner tonight. I'll have Asher come fetch you."

**MAC**

"Okay."

**6. EXT. MOLLY'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

Molly opens up the bag, revealing crab meat and bits of chicken. She hands some to Mac, along with sticks and string. The kids spend the night trying to lure something out in the wetlands, but nothing happens. A thunderstorm begins to brew, and the wind howls around them.

Suddenly, Molly's MOTHER calls her home, and the kids quickly pack up

**7. INT. NEW HOUSE - MAC'S ROOM - NIGHT**

That night, Mac looks out his bedroom window. The thunderstorm rages outside, the wind shaking the trees and tall grass. The power flickers, then goes out. Mac stares into the darkness, his eyes wide as he hears a loud crash from outside.

He presses his face closer to the glass, trying to make out what caused the noise, but all he can see are the blurred, glowing fireflies--now resembling eyes watching him through the storm.

**FADE OUT.**

**Tuesday**



## 1. EXT. HOUSE - MORNING

The morning sun casts long shadows as DALLAS steps outside, carrying a trash bag. He walks towards the bins, inspecting them for any sign of raccoon.

In the distance, MAC (10) sprints towards the mailbox, eager to grab the mail. As he opens the mailbox, he notices something unusual: a small burn mark on the ground. It's not large or round, but scattered and irregular.

Dallas notices Mac's hesitation and walks over, peering down at the mark.

Dallas frowns slightly but doesn't comment further. Mac collects the mail, and they head to the car.

Mac looks down - next to the lightning mark there is a single gem stone laying on the ground. Mac doesn't touch it - but goes into the car.

## 2. INT. CLASSROOM - DAY

The classroom buzzes with chatter as the TEACHER begins the day's lesson.

### TEACHER

"For those who were up last night,  
some of you may have heard a  
distant rolling thunder - Charlie  
- are you paying attention - Derek  
- hey!

The teacher throws a book on the ground

### TEACHER

I'm talking about boom thunder!  
And how long does thunder make a  
sound after lightning? Wake up  
people these are life long  
annedotes

Today, we'll be lightning forms--  
phenomena that are particularly  
interesting here on the coast."

As the teacher continues, Mac glances across the room at ASHER (10). The two exchange knowing looks. After class, Mac approaches Asher.

**MAC**

"Did you catch anything last night?"

Asher nods no.

**3. EXT. SCHOOL YARD - AFTERNOON**

School has just let out, and students are pouring out of the building. Mac spots MAKAYLA (12) waiting near the edge of the playground. She walks up to him, a serious expression on her face.

**MAKAYLA**

"Can I trust you?"

**MAC**

"Yeah."

Molly looks around cautiously before speaking.

**MAKAYLA**

"Do you know about secret professors? (What)? - A long time ago, there was a group of professors who started a secret society - they were from Yale but they lived in Branford - okay - anyway - They would search these exact coasts - for specific crustaceans that they would find on specific rocks, during a certain time of the season, which is now"

**MAC**

"Why are you telling me this?"

**MOLLY**

"Because we have to be certain-- that we get the right bait""

**MAC**

"Bait for what?"

**MOLLY**

"The creature."

#### **4. EXT. CORNER BEACH - DUSK**

The golden light of the setting sun bathes the beach in a warm glow. Molly, Asher, and Mac arrive with flashlights and ziplock bags. They begin collecting small crustaceans from the rocks, carefully placing them in the bags with a bit of seawater.

Molly finds Mac alone and begins to talk to him.

MAC and MOLLY sit on a driftwood log, the silence between them heavy. The distant sound of waves fills the air.

**MAKAYLA**

(after a long silence)

"What happened to your mom?"

**MAC**

(speaking softly)

"She died a long time ago. She got sick when I was two... and died when I was three."

**MAKAYLA**

"That's cool - my mom too -  
(pause) - so Why did you move here?"

**MAC**

"My dad got a job at Yale"

**MAKAYLA**

What does your dad do?

**MAC**

He does physics and nuclear theoretical stuff.

The atmosphere is tense. Strange, wild sounds echo in the distance, making the kids jump.

**ASHER**

"What was that?"

The kids freeze, glancing around. **MAKAYLA** grabs out a small audio recorder that she has - and motions for the rest of the crew to stay silent - but after the second cry - without a word, they quickly gather their things and rush to their bikes.

## **5. EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

Mac pedals home as fast as he can, the events of the evening still fresh in his mind. When he arrives, he sees Dallas outside, watching the bird feeder.

Without hesitation, Mac runs to him and gives him a tight hug.

DALLAS  
"What happened?"

Before Mac can answer, they both hear the strange sound together--carried on the wind from the direction of the beach. Dallas looks out into the darkness, his concern growing.

## **6. INT. NEW HOUSE - DINING ROOM - NIGHT**

Dallas and Mac sit down on their couch for dinner. Tension still lingers in the air, and they eat quietly. The distant sounds of the night mix with the clatter of utensils, adds to the growing sense of unease.

On the TV is the Weatherman - the same weatherman that was out in the day before. Talking about a hurricane that is quickly making a case. And how that is is hurricane season. Be on the look out

\*Develop this scene - watch footage of weathermen

**FADE OUT.**

# **Wednesday**

## **1. EXT. DRIVEWAY - EVENING**

Dallas and Mac drive to a neighbor's house for dinner. On the radio forecasts the evening weather and advertises the big Branford Sea Harvest Festival this next week.

CUT TO

**2. EXT. MOLLY'S BACKYARD DECK PARTY - EVENING**

The warm glow of the setting sun casts a golden light over the backyard. Laughter and the sounds of a BBQ sizzle in the background as neighbors mingle on the deck. Dallas stands with Dominic, a talkative neighbor, who is enthusiastically chatting away.

**DOMINIC**

(excitedly gesturing with  
his a fork of ziti)

Yeah, yeah, Hugo--my cousin--  
throws an annual charity event  
every summer. You'd really like  
him--his daughter's into all that  
sea stuff too. You and your son  
should join us. The kids can play,  
and we can all hang out.

Dallas smiles politely, but it's clear Dominic's energy is a bit overwhelming. Mac stands nearby, quietly listening to the conversation but not engaging, his eyes occasionally drifting to the edge of the backyard.

In the background, **MAKAYLA (12)**, carrying her backpack, approaches Dominic, and hugs him quickly. Molly then steps back, looking over at Mac as she pulls the straps of her backpack tighter.

**MAKAYLA**

(to Dominic)

Dad, I'm heading to the back with  
the others. I'll be back later.

**DOMINIC**

Okay, Just stay close - we have a  
lot of people over and you we're  
about to eat.

**MAKAYLA**

Yes, Dad.

Molly glances at Mac, making brief eye contact before turning and heading toward the far end of the backyard. She disappears into the twilight, her figure silhouetted against the setting sun as she makes her way toward the coast.

Dallas watches her leave, sensing something in the air, but he doesn't say anything. Dominic resumes his animated conversation, drawing Dallas back into the moment.

**DOMINIC**

So this charity event...

**3. EXT. MOLLY'S FAR BACKYARD BY THE COAST - AFTERNOON**

The deck party continues, the noise and laughter distant now as **MAC** wanders alone near the far end of Molly's backyard, which stretches all the way to the coast stuck in the last dog days of summer.

Mac stands still, staring out at the water. The waves roll in thickly, and their soft crash against the rocks fills the air. Mac scans the grass, looking for the mysterious eyes and then back to Makayla - who is pointing a telescope down at a certain part of the coastline.

Suddenly, he hears a faint whimper--a distant cry that sounds like an animal in pain, far off in the wilderness. The nautical sounds engulf him, heightening his fear. The grass rustles, but it's unclear if it's the wind or something else.

Frightened, Mac takes a step back, ready to head back to the safety of the deck party. But before he can leave, he's stopped by a group of kids emerging from the fog--**MOLLY**, **ASHER**, and a few others, including **MISTY (13)**, one of the older girls. They move with purpose, their faces serious.

Molly steps forward, her eyes focused on Mac.

MAKAYLA  
(firm, yet with a hint of  
urgency)  
Mac, give me that shovel.

Mac hesitates for a moment, unsure of what they're planning, but the determined look on Molly's face convinces him. He nods and runs to grab the shovel that's leaning against a nearby tree.

As he hands it over, Molly turns to the group, her expression shifting from determination to leadership.

MAKAYLA  
(lowering her voice, as  
if revealing a secret  
plan)  
Alright, we need to move quickly.  
The storm's coming, and if we're  
going to lure it out, this is our  
only shot. Asher, you're on  
lookout. Misty, make sure the  
bait's ready. We'll set the traps  
near the tall grass, just like we  
planned.

The other kids nod, following Molly's lead without question. Mac watches them, both intrigued and nervous. He knows they're about to do something dangerous, but the pull of the mystery--the chance to finally confront the creature--keeps him from backing out.

Molly catches Mac's eye, sensing his hesitation.

MAKAYLA  
(softly, with a hint of  
reassurance)  
You with us, Mac?

Mac takes a deep breath and nods.

Molly smiles briefly, then turns back to the group.

MAKAYLA

Let's go.

The kids, led by Molly, move deeper into the night, toward the farthest reaches of the backyard, where the grass is tallest and the coast drops off into the sea. The fog thickens, and the air grows colder, but they press on.

#### **4. EXT. CORNER BEACH - NIGHT**

The crew scours the corner beach, searching for evidence of lightning strikes and other burn marks. They find nothing. Molly suggests they head to "the fort."

MAC

"You guys have a fort?"

#### **5. EXT. THE FORT - LATE AFTERNOON**

The kids flock to their hideaway--a makeshift fort hidden among the tall grass. They begin laying traps made of various forms of food tied to driftwood sticks outside the fort.

MAKAYLA

"The creatures are likely to come from the sea, though my grandfather always said they come from the grass. They come from the sea first, then go into the grass."

JEFFERSON

(skeptical)

"How could you possibly know that?"

MAKAYLA

"Shut up Jefferson - you're lucky your even here."

The two exchange glances for a while.

A debate ensues among the kids about how the creature would behave on land, how it would move, and how it would scatter about the tall grass.



MISTY  
 (setting up a camera)  
 "Let's see if we can catch  
 something on film."

Molly watches Misty (Age 13) sets up an old digital point and shoot camera while the rest of the group prepares the bait, waiting for the thunderstorm to roll in.

#### **6. EXT. THE FORT - LATE AFTERNOON**

The kids gather around the monitor, displaying 4 or so camera feeds discussing what kind of monsters might arrive on land and how they might move from the sea to the grass. The conversation turns to Molly's father.

JEFFERSON  
 "Your grandfather was just writing  
 those stories to make you laugh.  
 He didn't believe in that stuff."

MISTY  
 Jefferson - - Mom says we have to  
 go back to the party.

MAKAYLA  
 "No--he actually did."

JEFFERSON  
 Okay that makes sense now

MISTY  
 Jefferson, we have to go back -  
 mom just texted me we got to go  
 now.

CUT TO

#### **EXT. EXT PARTY**

The kids hang back to the party. Mac approaches Dallas who is standing by himself in the hallway of the house - looking at family portraits - looking at wall mounted family portraits - photos of when the kids were little and what not. He looks at his son and smiles.

CUT TO

#### **EXT. TALL BEACHY**

## Thursday

### 1. INT. HOUSE - MORNING

Dallas begins to go inside, the sound of the breeze from the Long Island Sound rustling through the trees. He pauses, looking out at the sky before stepping through the door. From the corner of his eye - he spots a burn mark near the mailbox.

### 2. EXT. SCHOOL PLAYGROUND - AFTERNOON

Later that afternoon at recess, Mac finds Makayla standing by the soccer net, staring at some strange burn marks on the grass. She turns to him, her expression serious.

**MAKAYLA**

"My grandfather told me last night that it's happening. I can show you."

Mac hesitates but then nods.

**MAC**

"I thought your grandfather died."

### 1. INT. YOUTH GROUP CLASS - AFTERNOON

Mac looks around and notices that some of his classmates are also his Sunday School classmates. The Youth Pastor begins handing out papers on the topic of ancient Israelites and what we can learn from their mistaken ways of seeking atonement.

After the class, the Youth Pastor notices Mac sitting alone and goes over to console him.

### 2. EXT. CHURCH PARKING LOT

Mac sits alone as the rest of the kids parents pick up their from Youth Group. He watches everyone and their families go into their various mini vans.

The Youth Pastor notices mac sitting alone and joins him on the stoop.

**JERRY**

Mac, you seem deep in thought. Can I sit?

MAC

Yeah.

JERRY

Is your Dad coming to pick you up?

MAC

Yeah.

JERRY

That's good - that's good. First week - new town - new school - how's it going?

MAC

Good.

JERRY

Ah - that's good...

A group of seagulls

Yeah - I remember coming here from Georgia - wasn't used to these New England winters. But that's was away.

Mac continues to look onward.

MAC

Do you think there are creatures in other worlds?

JERRY

What's that?

MAC

The handout you gave before - and the talk after - you said that the \*\*\* came from \*\*\* to serve God.

JERRY

I did - yes.

MAC

So are there still creatures in this world?

JERRY

Hmmm. Well, maybe you could think of the creatures of the deep waters that we're still figuring out.

(MORE)

JERRY (CONT'D)

I think it's easy for us to get hung up on the logistics - - but if you think about it there are still - - ancient things - things we don't understand - we're discovering about dinosaurs and whatnot.

MAC

That's not what I mean. Makayla was talking about these creatures that she has been seeing in the tall grass - and now her and Asher and me are taking pictures of the tall grass.

JERRY

Makayla is interesting huh - she's come a long way since her father died.

MAC

I thought it was her grandfather that died.

JERRY

Is that what she said?

Dallas approaches and walks outside. He goes up to Jerry and shakes his hand - thank you - sorry I was late.

DALLAS

Sorry I was late - thank you - Mac walks into the car.

## **7. EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

That night, Mac steps outside and sees Dallas grilling. The smoke from the grill rises and catches the light, casting eerie shadows. Mac looks beyond the borders of their property, his gaze fixated on the tall grass swaying in the breeze.

Dallas notices him staring and follows his gaze, looking at the tall grass as well.

## **8. INT. MAC'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT**

Later, Mac walks back inside to find Dallas staring at the weather TV. Dallas notices Mac and gets up. The two sit together by the TV. Off in the distance - the wind pulls up.

**9. EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

That night, as they prepare for bed, a strange sound echoes through the house. The wind begins to pick up, rattling the windows. Dallas looks out into the night, the tall grass swaying ominously.

Outside there is a

**10. EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - NIGHT**

Dallas steps outside into the thunderstorm to make sure everything is secure. The wind howls around him as he checks the perimeter, a sense of unease settling in.

FADE OUT.

# FRIDAY.

**1. INT. MAC'S HOUSE - MORNING**

The next morning, the storm has passed, but the air is still heavy with the remnants of the previous night's events.

Dallas looks out and finds the seed from the bird feeder scattered about. Mac looks for the rocks.

**2. INT. School Class**

TEACHER

Not sure if you folks have been  
noticing the weather has been  
acting sproadic - johnny -  
sproadic

**3. INT. Saturday Morning - Around the Corner at the Beach**

The crew go wild with their bikes down the road - past the post office - and ride their bikes among the tiny costal sidewalks.

### **Media Class - School HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - AFTERNOON**

The crew--Makayla , Mac, and a few other kids--gather around a computer. They stand over a software editor, DaVinci Resolve, going frame by frame through various cameras and footage footage, scanning for any sign of eyes or other mysterious figures. Misty hands molly another camera - and she puts it into an SD card.

Nothing comes up.

\*Jefferson to Makayla - - hey - you showed Mac that dumb book yet?

### **SATURDAY #2**

#### **SATURDAY MORNING**

#### **EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - MORNING**

Dallas builds a bird feeder and looks at his creation. He then goes through the bucket and begins to do little gardening things.

He struggles at first to get started - but then in time he does and gets to it.

Mac looks in the bucket and finds an old fishing wire and a ring - he begins to make a little ring toss on a tree - across the street from the tall grass.

#### **Mac plays for a while \*\*\* put this earlier and later??**

Mac gets his bike and rides off.

CUT TO

#### **EXT. MAKAYLA'S HOUSE - MORNING**

Mac parks his bike outside Makayla and Ashers home. The talkative neighbor Dominic answers

DOMININC

Oh whats up Mr. Mac - what's shaking my friend? How's your dad?

MAC

He's okay

DOMINIC

You should tell him to call me  
sometime. You looking for Makayla?

MAC

Yeah - I have her \*Item.

Makayla comes running down the stairs with laptops, cam  
corders, (anything else she gets from ebay)

#### **NT. MAKAYLA'S GRANDPA'S STUDY - DAY**

Dust floats in the beams of light filtering through the  
worn curtains. The room is filled with old dvd covers, play  
houses, dust soaked blankets covering books, book chests,  
giving the impression of a horder is a horder books, maps,  
and trinkets from a life spent studying the strange and  
unknown. Makayla, Mac, and Asher all sit around a dusty  
laptop with a basic movie editor software.

**MAKAYLA**

(whispering, as if afraid  
to disturb the silence)

I was thinking we could  
triangulate the creature

MAC

How do you know all of this

**MAKAYLA**

Can I trust you?

Makayla pulls out an old, leather-bound journal from a  
shelf. The cover is embossed with strange, swirling symbols  
that seem familiar. He opens it carefully, revealing  
handwritten notes, sketches, and weather observations.

The kids gather around as Makayla flips through the pages.  
The journal is filled with cryptic entries, but one passage  
catches their attention. It's dated decades ago, when  
Makayla's grandfather was a young boy.

**MAKAYLA**

(excited, whispering)

This is a story our Grandfather  
wrote down. But it's not just any  
story --this is real. He saw them.

The kids exchange nervous glances. Makayla clears her throat and begins reading aloud, her voice filled with a mix of awe and fear.

MAKAYLA

(reading)

"Cold - summer night in September  
- Wednesday - 1925 - cold windy -  
outside - near the coast - far off  
in the distance I stood with my  
father - and we both saw the  
stones -

they were close at first - when I  
first saw the eyes - standing in  
the distance - I noted that the  
sunset seemed darker than most -  
not that it was night time. Night  
- night , darker than most nights.  
I was a boy, wandering through the  
woods near town... chasing after  
something I couldn't quite see,  
but I knew it was there..."

MAC

(leaning in, intrigued)

ASHER

(glancing around  
nervously)

Keep reading, Makayla.

Makayla turns the page, revealing a rough sketch of the costal tall grass and strange symbols drawn in the margins. Rock formations in little "karen" like places.

MAKAYLA

(continuing)

"The woods were dense I followed a  
faint, melodic hum... It sounded  
like a lullaby, but different--  
eerie and unearthly..."

MAKAYLA

(reading)

"I followed the sound deeper into  
the woods until I found them..."

(MORE)



MAKAYLA (CONT'D)

Creatures, not quite human, not quite animal--something in between. They moved through the shadows, their bodies shimmering like mist..."

Makayla flips to a page with a rough drawing of the creatures--figures that seem both beautiful and terrifying, with glowing eyes and ethereal forms.

MAKAYLA

(reading)

"They saw me too - and for a while  
- we stood at each other "

MAKAYLA

(pausing, showing the sketch)

This is what he saw. These... things... They were real.

MAC

(awed, barely above a whisper)

No way...

ASHER

(nervous, looking at the drawing)

They look... like ghosts - with just glowing eyes.

Makayla nods and continues reading, her voice growing more intense.

MAKAYLA

(reading)

"They were performing a ritual, placing stones and plants in a pattern on the ground. The wind picked up, but they didn't seem to notice.

(MORE)

MAKAYLA (CONT'D)

Their hum grew louder, almost like  
they were summoning something...  
And then, everything went silent."

Wind looks out the window - it is getting windy.

MAC

I think I should go home

MAKAYLA

What do you mean?

ASHER

It's getting windy.

MAC

My dad's been worried about the  
weather.

MAKAYLA

(determined, closing the  
journal)

We have to find out what happened  
next. If Grandpa saw them, then we  
can too. We just need to figure  
out what they want... before it's  
too late. I think they want the  
chicken on the stick

MAC

Okay - when do you want to do  
this?

MAKAYLA

We have to wait on the weather -  
for a true thunderstorm.

**MAKAYLA (V.O.)**

(continuing)

"One of the creatures stepped  
forward, extending a hand... I was  
frozen in place, unable to move or  
look away from its glowing eyes...  
I thought it was the end, but  
then..."

Makayla trails off, turning the page, but the rest of the  
entry is smudged, the words barely legible.

MAKAYLA  
 (frustrated)  
 I can't read the rest... It's like  
 he never finished it.

MAC  
 (frowning)  
 Or maybe... maybe something  
 stopped him from finishing it.

The kids sit in silence for a moment, absorbing what they've just read. The realization hits them--Makayla's grandfather encountered the creatures, and now, they're following the same path.

ASHER  
 (nodding, still nervous  
 but resolved)  
 Maybe they like the chicken on the  
 stick.... The crabs do

**CUT TO:**

**EXT. MAC'S BIKE RIDE HOME**

Mac looks as he rides his bike along the tall grass Mac looks for eyes.

As he walks home - he notices a dog in the distance acting weird - barking at the tall grass - something in the distance - with nothing seemingly going on - Mac rides faster.

**EXT. MAC'S HOUSE - OUTSIDE GARAGE**

He finds Dallas outside taking a measurement of the weather - he goes and watches his dad - and his dad explains a bit how it works.

Outside in the distance - a camera crew again looks out on something in the tall grass.

Mac is curious and walks over to see what is going on.

As he walks over - he sees another stone on the ground next to the other gemstone - he doesn't touch them but goes inside that night.

**INT. DINNER TIME**

Mac and Dallas watch TV as they eat.

News about the hurricane and how it is approaching landfall is all over the horizon.

Hurricane season they are calling it -

Mac looks out the window for the eyes - and sees a flicker at night.

That night it is windy and Mac wanders his eyes across the street at the tall grass.

SUNDAY #2

**INT. CHURCH SANCTUARY**

The church is buzzing with the talk of the town - apparently a very strange event happened to everything the night before.

Mac looks at different congregates hovering around a coffee pot as an older gentlemen hands out welcome cards. On the screen there are announcements for upcoming Harvest Festival - that the church is going to be a part of and run the kids crafts table apparently - volunteers are needed.

Mac and Dallas walk into the pew and sit behind a baby that stares at Mac

The piano begins

PASTOR JERRY

Please find a seat - our call to worship this morning is from the book of Isiah - Chapter 52 verse 25.

The projector screen reads.

Mac looks around for Makayla and Asher but they are not here this morning.

**EXT. CHURCH OUTSIDE FELLOWSHIP LUNCH**

Mac approaches Jerry and asks him if he has seen Makayla or Asher.

MAC

I was with them yesterday.

PASTOR JERRY

They were supposed to help out with the nursery room - all good - just not like their father to not bring them - okay - sorry - just wanted to make sure they were okay

**EXT. BEACH HOUSE**

Mac and Dallas approach their home from their walk. Mac runs over to the mailbox and.

Mac looks around the neighbors house but sees their car gone.

**MONDAY #2****INT. SCHOOL**

Mac checks the stones - they are still there. School begins and ends. The teacher talks about the weather more. Asher and Mac eat silently during lunch. Makayla's father takes them home.

Mac goes home that night and sees Makayla sitting alone -

**EXT. MAKAYLA'S HOUSE**

MAKAYLA

I saw the creature last night.

Mac's eyes widen.

MAKAYLA

It came.

Mac's eyes widen.

Asher's in the hospital.

MAC

Really?

MAKAYLA

We were going to get the footage before it got dark - and as we were approaching the camera - He saw the creature too and he ran away and he broke his leg - I stood there and stood still... we were there until late - and I was tired so I asked my dad if I could stay home from school today and he said it was okay - he took off work himself - Ashers in the hospital and we're going to go over after we shower and visit him - he should be back tomorrow.

MAC

Have you talked to him?

MAKAYLA

No - not really - I told him not to talk about what we were doing back there - as the adults would think would get all worried and start a big investigation and ruin our plans before they begin.

MAC

What do you see?

MAKAYLA

I saw eyes in the distance... And then - and then I don't know what happened - it was like - I was dreaming for a second - but then I woke up at it was gone - and Asher was crying in the distance.

MAC

Did you look at the footage?

Makayla Smiles.

CUT TO

**INT. HALF-FINISHED BASEMENT COMPUTER ROOM**

The crew look at a series of old CRT era laptops all haphazardly and hackerdly arranged - and then a big slow motion - and then nothing - and then asher crying - but a flash of light - and in the center as they zoom nothing - but as a filter is applied - some makeshift eyes appear

The dad comes downstairs and tells Makayla that they have to go - Mac needs to go home.

Cut to

**EXT. MAC HOUSE**

Dallas is out in the front yard looking at the gem stones and then he looks at Mac - Mac looks back - the two walk inside and check the wather.

TRANSITION INTO ACT 2 (

**EXT. MAC'S HOUSE**

School has been cancelled. Dallas turns on the TV - School has been cancelled - the hurricane is set to land fall.

Mac looks out the window outside and sees a bright sunny sky as Makayla and Asher arrive on bikes.

MAKAYLA

Can we use your sink\*?

**INT. MAC'S KITCHEN**

Dallas stands over the sink and washes dirt off potatoes - but moves out of the way when Makayla storms in.

Makayla begins to rattling on as she takes out an old metal instrument and begins to wash the dirt off of it.

MAKAYLA

I have a plan - I think the creatures have landed - I believe that they have come with the storm - and now - now, we are going to mark them.

Dallas putters around the kitchen - looking for a towel to dry his hands. and looks for a towel to wipe his hands.

Makayla hands Mac the instrument - still soaking wet - Dallas hands Mac the cloth.

Makayla and Dallas lock eyes. Asher bumps into the two as he carries a box full of instruments. They look like meat theomomentters - because they are.

CUT TO

EXT. MAC'S BACKYARD

Makayla shows Mac, Asher and now Dallas who is watching - her dig a little hole in the ground and plants the device in.

VO MAKAYLA

Creatures, like animals, give off heat... These are set to pick up temperature changes in the ground.

Makayla grabs something from her backpack - it is a interesting electrical device - she puts it on the ground as she searches for more materials and Dallas picks it up. Holding it close and inspecting it.

ASHER

Does it work?

Dallas looks at Asher in a concerned look. Dallas takes it into his workshop as the children continue.

MAKAYLA

He's going to fix it right? I think that one works - he'll figure it out. Here's another (she tosses it to Mac) - it's a trail cam - when we get the notice that the ground temperature changes - we'll know when on the timeline to go look for the footage. These are trail cams baby - grade A stuff - they will detect night vision and anything else.



Mac looks at the trail cam.

MAC  
Where do you want to hang them?

CUT TO

EXT. MAC'S BACKYARD - THE TREE TO HANG THE WIRE

Mac begins to use his fishing line kit to delicately tie the device down.

CUT TO

EXT. MAKAYLA'S BACKYARD

Mac hangs another deer cam - as Asher plants meat thermometers towards the edge of the tall grass.

CUT TO

EXT. NEIGHBORHOOD

The kids ride their bikes around - Makayla looks for another spot - Asher and Mac ride together.

ASHER  
Do you think they're really  
creatures in the tall grass?

MAC  
(Looking at Asher)  
Do you?

ASHER  
I think so - Makayla seems to  
think so at least.

EXT. MAC'S OUTSIDE - DUSK

The children arrive. Dallas comes outside with the device in his hand - he hands it over to Makayla. The two exchange looks and Makayla and Asher ride off.

Mac and Dallas go inside without saying much - and Dallas goes into the kitchen and continues to wash his potatoes.

INT. MAC'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Mac looks up at the stars on his bedroom ceiling - he looks at a picture of his mom - and then a faint cry is heard into the distance. It is like a cry of a wounded animal and then ceases to stop. Mac looks outside the window at the tall grass - and at first sees nothing - but then sees the eyes.

He slowly moves back into bed - and then goes out and looks out the window again - but nothing.

WEDNESDAY #2

INT. MAC'S KITCHEN

Mac answers the phone.

MAC  
That was an automatic message -  
School has been cancelled again.

Dallas and Mac look at each other.

MAC  
That means your school is  
cancelled too?

Dallas nods.

EXT. MAC'S OUTSIDE

The wind picks up - Mac goes and checks